

THE INTERNATIONAL PORSCHE GARAGE

Porsche Cayenne Buyer's Checklist — 12 things to check before you buy

- ☐ **1. Coolant pipes (V8)**
955/957 V8s have plastic coolant pipes that fail — a \$3,000+ engine-out job. Check for replacement history.
- ☐ **2. Transfer case & prop shaft**
Clunks on takeoff or vibration at speed = worn transfer case or centre bearing. Listen on a slow tight turn.
- ☐ **3. Air suspension**
Sagging corner overnight or a constantly running compressor means struts or compressor are tired.
- ☐ **4. Engine specifics**
957 V8: timing chain wear. 955 3.2 V6: balance-shaft issues. 958: check coolant crossover pipes.
- ☐ **5. Service history**
Full stamps, ideally Porsche or recognised specialist. Skipped services on these kill gearboxes and engines.
- ☐ **6. Brakes**
Enormous and expensive. Check pad depth and disc lips — a full axle set can top \$1,500 in parts alone.
- ☐ **7. Tyres**
Staggered sizes, N-rated only. Check date codes and inner-edge wear (alignment goes with worn arms).
- ☐ **8. Electrics**
Early cars suffer battery drain and module gremlins. Everything electrical must work — test it all.
- ☐ **9. Sunroof drains**
Blocked drains flood the footwells and kill electronics. Lift the carpets and sniff for damp.
- ☐ **10. Towing history**
Check the tow hitch for heavy use. Gearbox and cooling system suffer if it's hauled caravans uphill for years.
- ☐ **11. Pre-purchase inspection**
A Porsche specialist PPI with a fault-code scan. Non-negotiable on a car this complex.
- ☐ **12. Title & accident history**
HPI check (UK) or Carfax (US). These get worked hard — mismatched panels tell the story.

Buying the car is step one — keeping it alive is the rest. Our workshop manuals cover every job on this list, step by step.

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